IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 34

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Orde	
2	5	
3	24	
4	serrated	serrated edge
5	6 December	6th December, December 6, December 6th
6	sleeves	protective sleeves
7	B	
8	C	
9	A	
10	B	
11	C	
12	F	
13	A	
14	H	
15	D	
16	B	
17	photo ID	photographic ID
18	hygiene line	
19	sample lot	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	dispatch lane	
21	student union	
22	typeface	
23	viewing distance	
24	decision time	
25	route error	
26	B	
27	A	
28	C	
29	B	
30	C	
31	avalanche face	
32	grain sizes	grain size
33	low	
34	moisture	
35	resonant layer	
36	angle	
37	frequency	
38	roundness	
39	vibration	
40	measurements	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Ruairi Gorseby	Good afternoon, EdgeRound mobile sharpening. We collect domestic kitchen knives across Cork on scheduled rounds. I can record the booking now; may I begin with your surname?
Tamsin Orde	It is Orde, O-R-D-E. The earlier note saying Ward is not correct, so please enter Orde on the collection label.
Ruairi Gorseby	Thanks. How many knives are you sending? Please count each small knife separately, but leave out scissors and garden tools because this round cannot take them.
Tamsin Orde	There is a chef’s knife, a bread knife, one utility knife and two paring knives. That makes 5 knives altogether, not four.

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Ruairi Gorseby	I also need the length of the longest blade, measured from heel to tip. Is that the chef's knife, and have you been able to measure it?
Tamsin Orde	Yes, the chef's knife is the longest. Its blade measures 24 centimetres from heel to tip; the handle is not included.
Ruairi Gorseby	Good. Most ordinary edges use our standard process, but serrated blades are marked separately. Do any of the five have that special edge?
Tamsin Orde	Four have plain edges. The bread knife is the only one with a serrated edge, so that is the special edge on the form.
Ruairi Gorseby	Now for collection: the fifth of December is already full, but the following morning has a nine-to-eleven window. Would that date suit you?
Tamsin Orde	Yes, please book 6 December. I can be at home during the morning window and hand the sealed box to the driver.
Ruairi Gorseby	Before collection, put every blade in protective sleeves so no edge can move or cut through the box. Newspaper by itself is not secure enough.
Tamsin Orde	I have proper sleeves. One knife also has a bent-looking tip, although its handle is firm and the blade is a normal length. Will that affect the price?
Ruairi Gorseby	Possibly. Because the tip is damaged, the workshop must inspect it before pricing any reshaping. A loose handle or unusual length is not the issue here.
Tamsin Orde	That makes sense. For the return, workshop collection is free and the next van is cheaper, but I will be away then. I choose the tracked return parcel.
Ruairi Gorseby	Fine. On the outer box, write only the booking code. Put your contact details inside; do not write the knives' value or the word fragile outside.
Tamsin Orde	All right. Can the driver tell me the total when the box is collected, or do I wait until somebody has examined all five knives?
Ruairi Gorseby	The driver cannot price them. We confirm the final cost after the workshop completes its condition inspection, and we contact you before any repair beyond sharpening.
Tamsin Orde	Do I need to wash or oil the blades before I pack them? I would rather not do anything that makes the sleeves slippery.
Ruairi Gorseby	Just wipe away food and keep the box dry; a little existing oil is acceptable. If a cracked handle is found, we send photographs and you may decline that repair.
Tamsin Orde	Perfect. I will sleeve all five knives, write the booking code outside and keep my contact details inside. Please send the collection window with the instructions.
Ruairi Gorseby	I will send everything now, including safe handover guidance and the return choice. The workshop will update you after inspection before carrying out any additional work. Please check all details carefully.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

Elodie Marwick	Welcome to Riverside Produce Auction. Today's visit follows a one-way route so that the public can see how lots are inspected and sold without entering working areas. Keep your plan in front of you as I describe the site.

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Elodie Marwick	From the southern entrance, look to the far left, the north-west corner. The raised public gallery occupies that corner.
Elodie Marwick	North is at the top of the plan. The visitor entrance is centred on the south wall. The western service lane is used by forklifts and delivery vehicles, so it is never part of the public route.
Elodie Marwick	The bidding hall is the large open space in the centre, not the smaller office against the north wall.
Elodie Marwick	Registration confirms the group list and issues a temporary badge. It does not register you as a commercial buyer. Anyone taking part in the short demonstration receives a separate numbered card.
Elodie Marwick	Directly east of the gallery, before you reach the cold rooms, you will see the sample bench.
Elodie Marwick	The gallery gives a clear view of the floor. Please remain behind the rail. Staff may bring representative produce to the sample area, but visitors do not open crates or enter the cold-storage zone.
Elodie Marwick	The insulated rooms grouped along the north-east wall are the cold rooms.
Elodie Marwick	A bidding clock will be demonstrated slowly. In normal trading it moves quickly, yet today the operator pauses it so the guide can explain price changes. The sample transaction is cancelled after the demonstration.
Elodie Marwick	Follow the visitor route down to the south-east corner. The wash point is beside the exit but outside the bidding hall.
Elodie Marwick	Hygiene boundaries matter because unpacked produce is being handled nearby. The public wash point is provided at the end of the route; the staff wash area beyond the line is not available to visitors.
Elodie Marwick	The permit desk is immediately beside the southern entrance, so visitors register before entering the main route.
Elodie Marwick	At departure, badges are returned near the exit. If a visitor has made an authorised purchase, staff attach a collection slip and move the box to the dispatch side. Nobody carries goods back through the gallery.
Elodie Marwick	At that desk, visitors first show photo ID. A booking email alone does not complete registration.
Elodie Marwick	The yellow hygiene line separates the public route from produce handling. Only staff may cross it, even after bidding has ended.
Elodie Marwick	For the bidding explanation, the auctioneer uses a small sample lot, not an entire commercial consignment.
Elodie Marwick	If you buy anything during the supervised session, boxes are collected later from the dispatch lane on the west side.

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Elodie Marwick	Visitors often ask whether they can photograph the auction. Wide views from the gallery are allowed during the demonstration, but staff faces, buyer cards and computer screens must not be photographed. The guide will identify a safe point before anyone uses a camera. The cold rooms are visible through windows but remain restricted because doors open onto a working vehicle route. Near the sample bench, labels show produce grade and lot number. They are examples for orientation, not promises about quality. Payment for an authorised visitor purchase is completed at the permit desk after the tour, never on the bidding floor. A collection slip is then matched with the box at dispatch. If the auction alarm sounds, visitors leave by the nearest marked exit and do not retrace the full one-way tour. Guides and staff account for the group outside the southern fence.
Elodie Marwick	We will now walk to the permit desk in pairs. Please keep the central doorway clear for auction staff.

Part 3 - educational/training discussion

Merrick Thorneby	Priyanka, our tutor’s main concern was that we had mixed legibility with navigation. A sign may be easy to read yet still produce a poor route choice. We need measures for both the immediate decision and the eventual path.
Priyanka Shawl	The route should start at the student union. Beginning in the design studio would make the building too familiar to our volunteers.
Merrick Thorneby	The campus route has four junctions. Two are visually simple and two contain competing doors and noticeboards. If every participant sees the signs in one fixed order, fatigue could be confused with the spacing condition.
Priyanka Shawl	Across all conditions we keep the same typeface. Otherwise a change attributed to spacing could actually come from letter shape.
Merrick Thorneby	We should control wording too. Each destination name will contain a similar number of letters, and the arrow size remains constant. Colour contrast and illumination must be checked before the session rather than treated as experimental factors.
Priyanka Shawl	We will mark a fixed viewing distance on the floor before each choice point, so everyone first sees the sign from the same position.
Merrick Thorneby	Decision time can be recorded automatically when the participant crosses the floor marker. Completion time covers the whole route, but it includes walking speed, so it belongs in a secondary analysis.
Priyanka Shawl	Our main outcome should be decision time: the interval from the sign becoming visible to the participant choosing a direction.
Merrick Thorneby	Participants need a neutral task, such as locating a booked tutorial room. If we tell them the experiment is about typography, they may stare at letter forms instead of navigating naturally.
Priyanka Shawl	If the participant enters the wrong corridor, we record a route error, even if they notice and correct it immediately.
Merrick Thorneby	The pilot is intended to expose practical faults. A staff member unfamiliar with this building is suitable because the person can follow instructions but cannot rely on a remembered shortcut.
Priyanka Shawl	Three sign heights seemed useful, but height would add another changing variable. We need to isolate spacing first.

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Merrick Thorneby	For analysis, each participant sees all spacing levels, but the order is counterbalanced. We will also note corrected errors separately so that a brief hesitation does not count as a successful direct route.
Priyanka Shawl	Let us use three predefined spacing levels: standard, moderately open and very open. We should not adjust them for individuals.
Merrick Thorneby	After the pilot, we can decide whether a larger study needs eye tracking. For now, a camera at the junction and a timing sensor are sufficient and less intrusive.
Priyanka Shawl	For the pilot, recruit staff who are unfamiliar with the building. Design students may recognise our manipulation, and library users know the route.
Merrick Thorneby	The camera should frame the choice point and record movement. We do not need faces or a recording of anyone reading aloud.
Priyanka Shawl	I will draft the consent form, while Merrick prepares the randomised sign sequence so the conditions are not always presented in the same order.
Merrick Thorneby	We should decide how many practice junctions participants receive. One unscored example can confirm that they understand the task and the timing marker, but it must use a sign not repeated in the main route. Too much practice would make the study about learning our system. At every junction, the destination wording should remain visible for the same duration. If a participant walks back to reread a sign, the timer continues and the observer records a reconsideration. We must distinguish that from a route error, which requires entering the incorrect corridor. The camera files will be named with participant codes and junction numbers. Audio will not be collected, because speech is irrelevant to the hypothesis and would add personal data. After the route, participants can comment on comfort and clarity, but those opinions should not replace behavioural measures. A person may prefer wide spacing even if it produces slower decisions. The analysis can report both outcomes without assuming they must agree.
Priyanka Shawl	That leaves the information sheet and risk assessment. We can divide those after Merrick has produced the sign sequence.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Lecturer	Booming dunes are memorable because a familiar material produces an unfamiliar acoustic effect. The sound is not made by wind whistling across the crest. It accompanies the collective motion of sand on a steep slip face.
Lecturer	The event begins when dry sand avalanches down the steep avalanche face of a dune, whether the movement starts naturally or is triggered carefully.
Lecturer	Not every dune booms. Shape alone is insufficient, and even a known booming dune may remain quiet after rain. Researchers therefore examine the material, the recent weather and the way an avalanche is initiated.
Lecturer	Booming material often contains grains within a narrow range of grain sizes; a broad mixture does not necessarily move in the same coordinated way.
Lecturer	Individual grain collisions produce brief impulses, but the audible tone persists. The central scientific question is how many moving grains become sufficiently coordinated for energy to concentrate around one frequency.
Lecturer	Instead of a sharp crack, observers hear a sustained tone with a relatively low frequency, sometimes lasting while the avalanche continues.

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Lecturer	One family of explanations emphasizes synchronization within the flowing layer. Another gives a larger role to a subsurface layer that could amplify or select vibrations. Field evidence has not removed every disagreement between these models.
Lecturer	Dryness matters. Too much moisture between grains can prevent the sound even when the slope and movement look suitable.
Lecturer	Careful measurement separates description from mechanism. Researchers map the slope, record humidity and temperature, and take small samples without assuming that one convenient correlation establishes a cause.
Lecturer	One proposed explanation involves a resonant layer beneath the surface, although its exact role remains debated and should not be presented as settled.
Lecturer	Acoustic data include frequency, amplitude and duration. Vibration sensors add information that a microphone in the air cannot provide. High-speed images can estimate flow speed, but they do not directly reveal forces between grains.
Lecturer	In a field survey, the team first records the slope angle at the active face before disturbing the sand.
Lecturer	Laboratory experiments allow grain properties to be controlled, though a small box cannot reproduce the full geometry of a dune. Field observations preserve scale but introduce changing wind, moisture and surface history.
Lecturer	A calibrated microphone records the sound frequency and its change through time rather than relying on the listener’s description alone.
Lecturer	The best interpretation therefore combines settings. If a model explains only one artificial avalanche, it is incomplete. If it predicts when sound will stop after moisture changes, it becomes more persuasive, but still requires replication.
Lecturer	Collected grains are tested for size and roundness, since similar-looking sands may differ in surface form.
Lecturer	Small buried sensors detect vibration beneath the moving surface and show whether oscillation extends into deeper material.
Lecturer	Finally, competing models are compared with field measurements. A plausible mechanism must explain observations at more than one dune.

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Lecturer	Booming is also distinct from the brief squeak produced when a small handful of sand is rubbed or pushed. The field phenomenon involves a much larger moving mass and can be heard at a considerable distance. That difference in scale is one reason a laboratory imitation remains difficult. Grain surfaces change through transport. Wind sorts particles and repeated collisions can alter their shape or coating. Researchers compare booming and silent sands, yet a sample removed from its dune may behave differently once humidity and packing change. The history of the surface matters too. A recent avalanche can expose material with different temperature or moisture from the uppermost layer. Repeating a test at the same location is therefore not necessarily an identical replication. To investigate synchronization, teams compare the tone with the motion of grains and subsurface vibration. A stable frequency during changing flow speed poses a different challenge to a model than a frequency that tracks speed closely. Uncertainty should be retained in the conclusion. A resonant layer is an important hypothesis, not a hidden instrument that has been directly observed at every booming dune. Likewise, similar grain size is often associated with booming but does not guarantee it. The combined evidence points to collective motion under restricted material and environmental conditions. Future work benefits from standard reporting of weather, slope, sampling depth and acoustic calibration, so apparently conflicting observations can be compared rather than treated as simple contradictions. Comparable records also reveal whether the same mechanism remains plausible across seasons and sites.
Lecturer	The broader lesson is methodological: striking sounds invite simple stories, whereas the evidence demands measurements across grains, flow and the dune body.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	iv	
2	vii	
3	i	
4	vi	
5	iii	
6	v	
7	ii	
8	winding key	
9	governor	
10	pinned cylinder	
11	tuned teeth	
12	specialised tools	
13	cylinders	
14	A	
15	B	
16	C	
17	D	
18	A	
19	B	
20	C	
21	pressure variations	
22	wavelength	
23	apparatus	
24	camera	
25	evaporate	
26	control margin	
27	NO	
28	YES	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	NO	
30	YES	
31	NOT GIVEN	
32	NO	
33	YES	
34	B	
35	C	
36	A	
37	D	
38	A	
39	B	
40	C	

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